Charts that tell the truth

Data science · Level 1 · Lesson 3



In this lesson you will

- Choose bar, line, pie or scatter for a question.
- Spot a cut axis.
- Read a chart’s title, axes and units.

Key ideas

- Bars compare groups; lines show time.
- Pies: a few parts of one whole.
- Bars start at zero.

Honest and tricky charts

1. Warm-up (5 min): Spot the trick
2. Draw (10 min): The honest chart.
3. Trick (10 min): The tricky chart.
4. Wrap-up (5 min): What did you find out?

Let’s discuss

1. Why does the scale need to start at zero?
2. Which chart fits your question?
3. What labels did you nearly forget?

Exit ticket

- Draw a tiny honest bar chart of two numbers, with a title and labelled axes.